

KOLKATA | London Dreams



Mamata Banerjee might have pushed the Nano out of West Bengal, but she has promised to turn the state into a paradise—once her party comes to power in the upcoming civic elections. With European cities being her prototypes, Banerjee's remark that she would turn Kolkata into London had Chief Minister Buddhadeb Bhattacharya in splits. When asked, "Why London?" Banerjee said that she would make Kolkata as clean as the UK capital. Bhattacharya has held his peace (or should that be laughter) on that one, but some of his confidants say Banerjee is talking frequently about London to keep her options open with its non-resident Bengalis. After all, an open invitation to visit those industrialist folk in the UK is pending for a long time.

by Abhijit Dasgupta

MUMBAI | Dress Down

Postmen in Mumbai have found a novel way to protest against the poor quality of uniforms: they will report to duty in shorts and vests. "Postmen are supposed to receive khaki uniforms every two years, but they haven't got it for four years now," said C.B. Surve, circle secretary of

NONE OF THE 13 CITIES, WHERE THE EURO-IV FUEL NORM WAS TO COME INTO FORCE FROM APRIL 1, HAS IMPLEMENTED IT.

DELHI | Fuel for Thought

So much for the talk of climate change. The Government had notified the implementation of Euro-IV emission norms for trucks and buses (5-49 tonnes category) from April 1. To date, no commercial vehicle has been made available at retail outlets and dealerships in 13 cities, including Delhi and others in Uttar Pradesh, Haryana and Rajasthan. Nor do dealers across India have price list, technical details or inventory relating to vehicles with Euro-IV norms. S.P. Singh, senior fellow and coordinator, Indian Foundation of Transport Research and Training, says it is a ploy by manufacturers to continue with pollutant Euro-II vehicles.

by Nivedita Mukherjee



Illustration by SAURABH SINGH/www.indianexpress.com

A POPULAR LEADER, HE WAS A MASTER AT POLITICAL MANOEUVERING

OBITUARY | B.S. SHEKHAWAT 1923-2010

To describe Bhairon Singh Shekhawat merely as the former vice-president (V-P) does no justice to his 50 years in politics. A shrewd politician, popular leader and a master at political manoeuvring, he was one of the founder members of the Bharatiya Jan Sangh-turned-BJP. Starting as a sub-inspector in state police, Shekhawat was a towering personality in Rajasthan politics and its three-time chief minister. He was saddened when the BJP did not back him for presidency in 2007. In the run-up to 2009 elections, he said that he deserved to be the prime ministerial candidate. The BJP has lost a man of ambition and achievement.

by Bhavna Vij-Aurora



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the All India Postal Employees' Union. The blue uniform they got last year are wearing out along with the bags, which are too shoddy to bear the weight of mails. Almost 2,500 postmen are going to work in civil clothes and may go on strike to get wearable uniforms.

by Mitali Patel